

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 15, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m8a-x35h-u3r1
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: Web

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-4194

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

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General Comment

Owners and executives of generative AI companies have been quoted on record as saying that if they cannot steal copyrighted materials for their AI models to be "trained" on, if they must pay royalties to rights holders and ask consent from creators before raiding entire entertainment companies of their intellectual property, their business cannot function. If a business cannot function unless it breaks the law, that business does not deserve to exist. In ANY OTHER industry, theft of copyrighted materials is a crime, as real a damage to the rights holder(s) as if you had broken into their home and stolen cash from a safe. No form of "artificial intelligence" should be exempt from the law. Copyright MUST be legally honored, across ALL businesses, or copyright itself no longer exists, and ALL people are free to use copyrighted material for any purpose they please, without a cent of royalties required. In corporate American's desperate bid to eliminate creative employees by replacing them with generative AI (that STILL requires human correction to be at all usable in a commercial capacity,) they're going to cut off their own arms and legs, in the form of legally rendering their own intellectual properties into public properties, as one will only need to claim "I made this with AI" to then have full legal rights to use anything from the McDonald's logo on a series of condom wrappers, to the blueprints of Starlink satellites on toilet paper, and no legitimate court will be able to stop nor punish any of it, because the chase for AI supremacy pipe dream will have destroyed all legal basis for complaint of damages by its owners' own hands. The US government bellyaches about how Chinese businesses steal intellectual properties to sell bootleg and counterfeit products all over the world, then champions "artificial intelligence" companies for the exact same business model, simply because the elimination of an entire industry of human employees boosts profit margins in a business field where EVERY generative AI venture has been bleeding out BILLIONS of dollars with no sight of a profit ever being reached. Generative AI, as a business, has been madness from the start; exempting AI from copyright laws will be akin to giving a madman a knife in each hand and setting him loose on Wall Street. There will be only financial suffering, and all for a product no one in the public sphere wants.